USER MANUAL · WORKFLOW

Workflows, tasks and forms

How work moves through Capitra: who gets each task, how to work it, how to build and change a workflow, and how forms, data fields, versions and out of office fit together. Written for everyone who works tasks, and for the workflow administrators who design them.

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Covers My Inbox · Designer · Versions · Data fields · Forms · Data sources · Start a workflow · Out of office



0 Quick start

The four jobs people do most often. Each one links to the full explanation.

EVERY DAY

Work a task

1. Inbox (top bar) or Workspace → My Inbox
2. **Claim** the task
3. **Start work**
4. Do the work on its screen or form, then **Approve**, **Reject** or **Complete**

WHEN YOU NEED SOMETHING

Start a workflow

1. Workspace → Start a Workflow
2. Choose the workflow
3. Fill in its form
4. **Start workflow**: the first task goes to whoever the workflow names

BEFORE LEAVE

Set out of office

1. Workspace → Out of Office
2. Choose who works your tasks
3. All workflows or one, and the dates
4. **Save**: your tasks go to them while you are away

WORKFLOW ADMINISTRATORS

Give a step a form

1. In the designer, add the **Data Fields**
2. Workspace → Workflow Forms → **New form**
3. Add the fields, choose drop-down lists
4. In the designer, pick the form on the step

1 About this manual

The workflow engine moves work between people. Each workflow is a diagram of steps; each human step becomes a **task** in someone's inbox. When the task is done, the workflow moves to the next step on its own. The engine also keeps a full history: who did what, when, and with what decision.

PAGE	WHERE	WHO USES IT
My Inbox	Inbox button in the top bar, or Workspace → My Inbox	Everyone who works tasks
Start a Workflow	Workspace → Start a Workflow	Everyone, for workflows that have a start form
Out of Office	Workspace → Out of Office, or the button on My Inbox	Everyone; administrators can set it for others
Workflow Engine	Workspace → Workflow Engine	Administrators: live tasks and their SLA
Workflow Registry and Designer	Workspace → Workflow Registry	Workflow administrators
Workflow Forms and Data Sources	Workspace → Workflow Forms / Data Sources	Workflow administrators

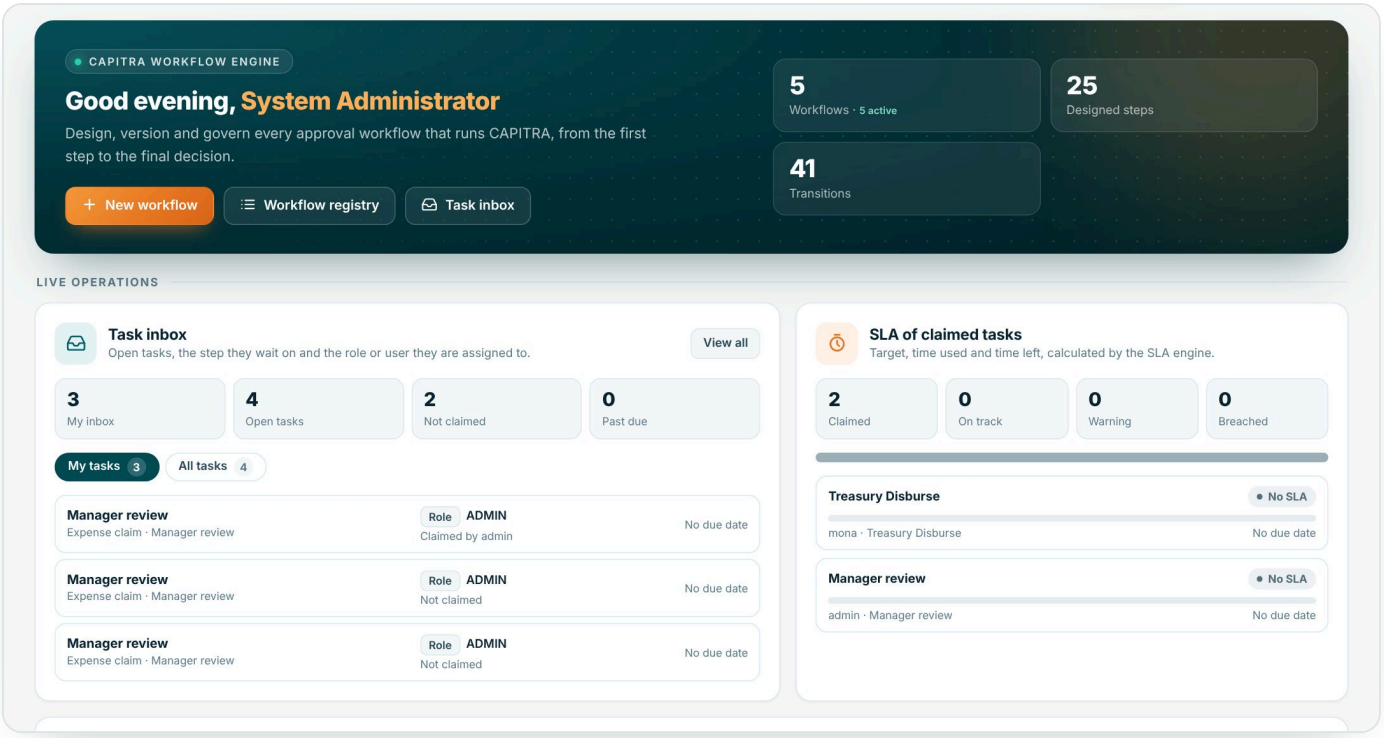


Figure 1. Workflow Engine home: how many workflows and steps exist, the open tasks and the SLA of claimed tasks.

> **NOTE** Everything in sections 4 to 6 and 8 to 9 was added on top of the existing engine. A workflow that does not use versions, data fields, forms or out of office runs exactly as before.

2 Key ideas

IDEA	WHAT IT MEANS
Workflow	A diagram of steps (BPMN) with a code, e.g. `DISBURSEMENT_REQUEST_WF`. Only a **released**, active workflow can start.
Instance	One run of a workflow for one business record (a disbursement, a claim). It carries its own data and history.
Step	A box in the diagram. A human step creates a task; a system step or a decision runs on its own.
Task	The work waiting at a human step, shown in the inbox of a role or one user.
Claim	Taking a task so that it is yours. A role task is visible to everyone in the role until someone claims it.
Outcome	How a task ended: APPROVE, REJECT, RETURN, COMPLETE... The arrow with the same name decides the next step.
Business screen	A Capitra page a step opens (its **Route**), such as Treasury Disburse. The task is completed from that page.
Version	A frozen copy of a released workflow. Running instances keep their version when the workflow changes.
Data field	A value each instance carries (amount, client, decision), with a type that is checked.
Form	A page laid out over the data fields, used on a step or at the start, for steps that have no business screen.
Data source	A list of values a form's drop-down offers: users, clients, currencies, or a list you keep.
Out of office	Who works your tasks while you are away, between two dates.

3 Designing a workflow

Workspace → **Workflow Registry** lists every workflow with its code, version, status and whether it is active. Open one to edit it in the designer, or use **New workflow**.

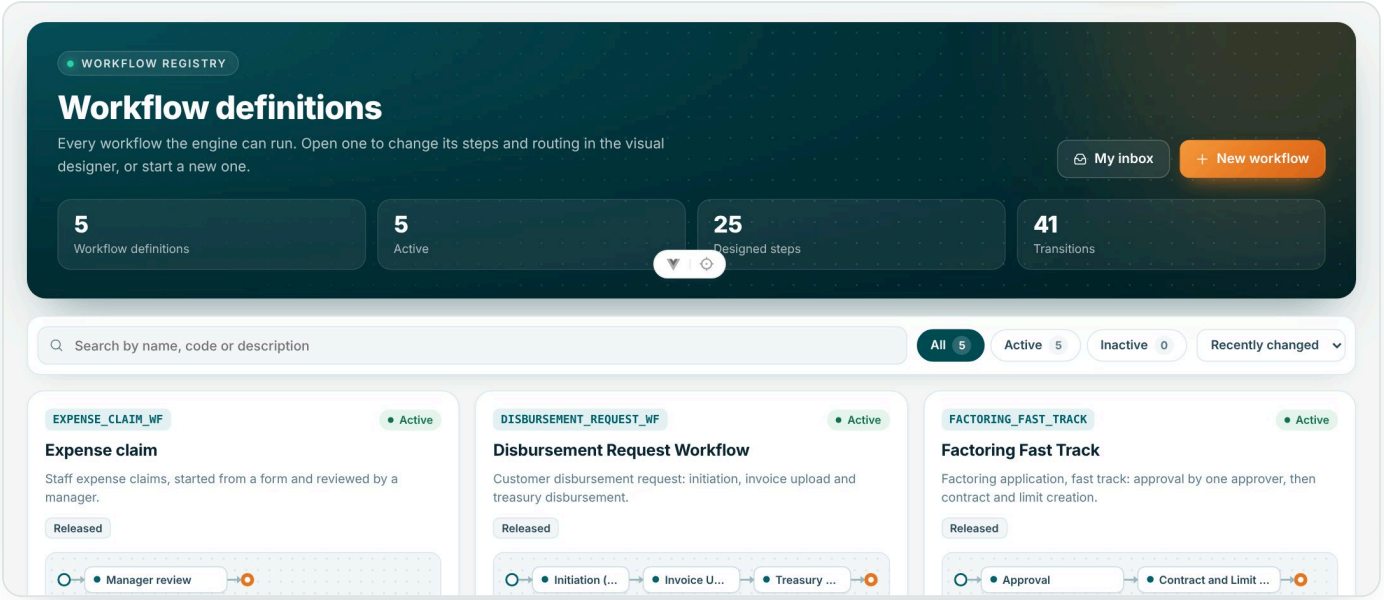


Figure 2. Workflow Registry.

The designer

Drag elements from **Tools** onto the canvas and connect them with arrows. Click an element to open its **Properties** on the right. The header holds Fit, **Versions** (section 4), **Data Fields** (section 5), BPMN XML and **Save Workflow**.

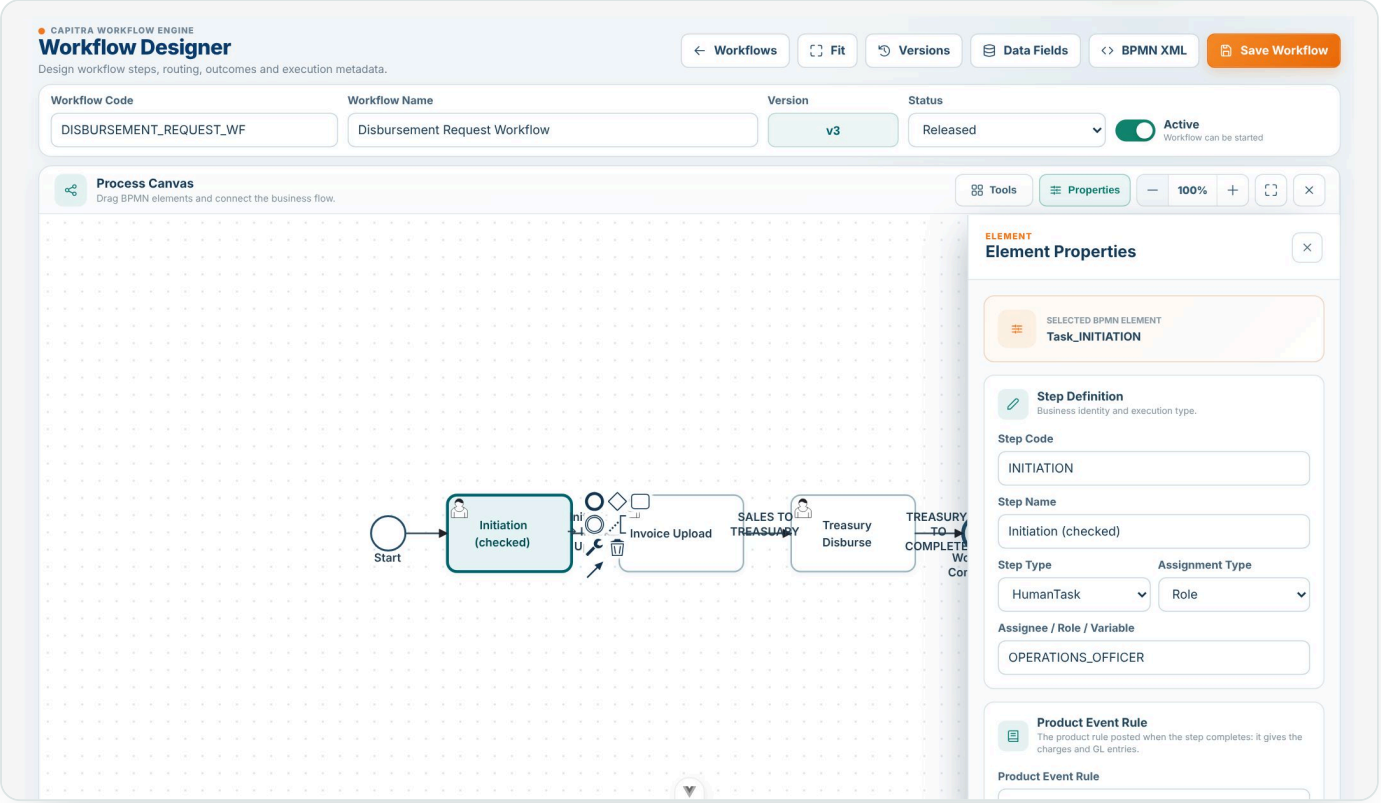


Figure 3. The designer with the Initiation step selected. The version chip shows **v3**.

Step settings

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Step Code	A stable code such as `TREASURY_DISBURSE`. Modules recognise steps by it, so keep it once in use.
Step Name	What people see in the inbox.
Step Type	HumanTask (creates a task), SystemTask, Decision, Start, End.
Assignment	**Role** (everyone in the role sees it) or **User** (one person, by user name in Assignee).
Product Event Rule	The product rule posted when the step completes: its charges and GL entries.
Form	The form people fill in at this step, or at the start (section 6).
Route / Page	The business screen the task opens, with its parameters. Leave empty for a step worked on its form.
Actions	The buttons that complete the task: APPROVE, REJECT, RETURN, COMPLETE... CLAIM is the claim button, not an outcome.

Arrows and outcomes

When a step has more than one arrow out, name each arrow after an outcome (APPROVE, REJECT). The task's outcome picks the arrow. With one arrow, any outcome follows it.

Saving and releasing

1. Set **Status** to **Released** and leave **Active** on, so the workflow can start.
2. **Save Workflow**. If the steps or arrows changed, Capitra makes a new version (section 4).
3. A Draft workflow can be saved as often as you like; it cannot start.

4 Versions

Each time a released workflow is saved with changed steps or arrows, Capitra keeps the old one as a version and the change becomes the new current version. Instances already running stay on the version they started with, so a change never breaks work in progress. Moving boxes around (layout only) does not make a new version.

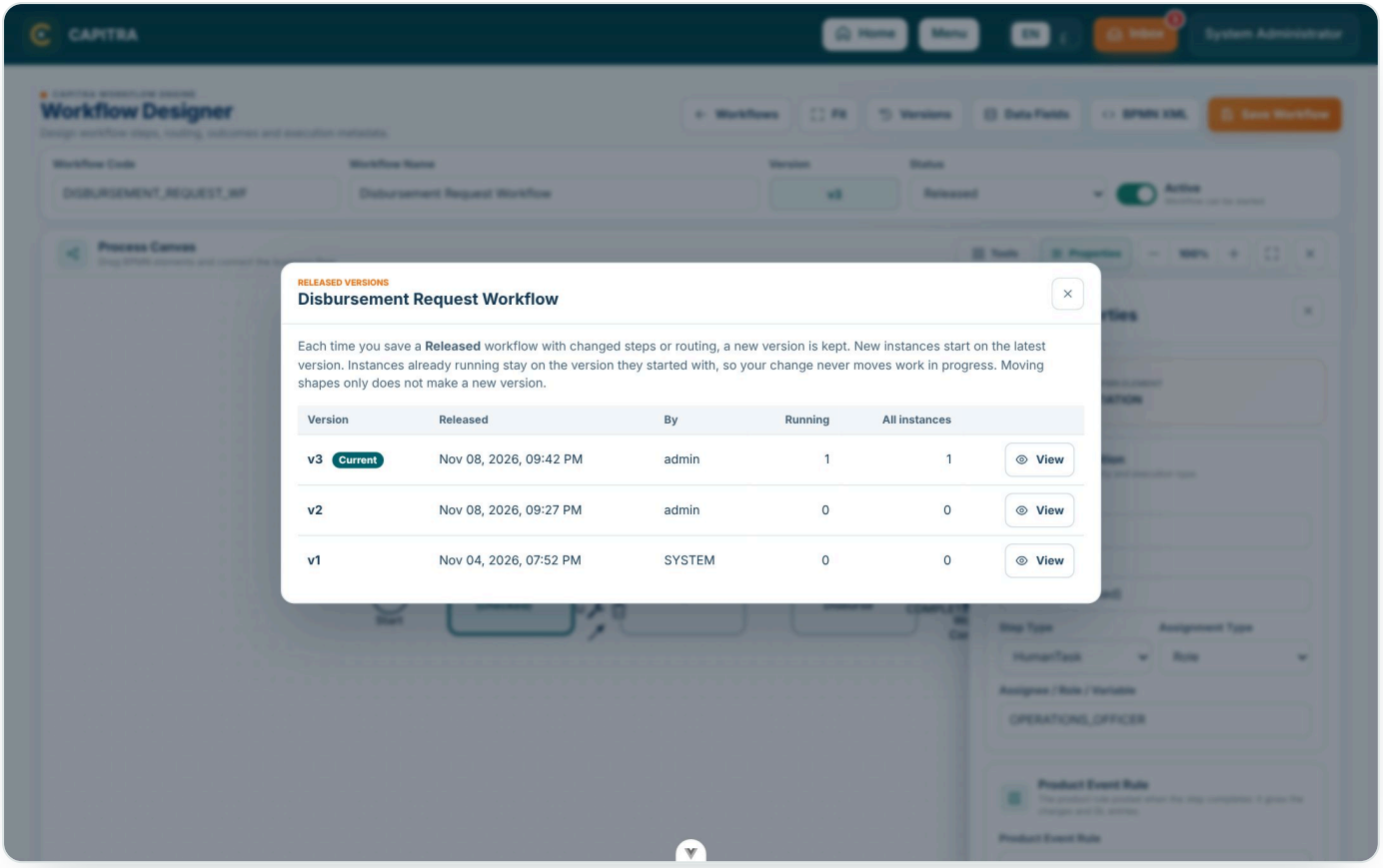


Figure 4. Versions: who released each one and when, how many instances run on it, and which is current.

- **View** opens an old version read-only. A banner says so; **Back to current workflow** returns.
- Save is off while you look at an old version.
- The version number is set by Capitra and shown in the chip beside the code.

5 Data fields

Data fields are the values each instance of a workflow carries: the amount, the client, the decision. Open them with **Data Fields** in the designer. Each field has a name (what screens and forms use, keep it once in use), a label, a type, whether it is required, a default and, for Choice, its choices.

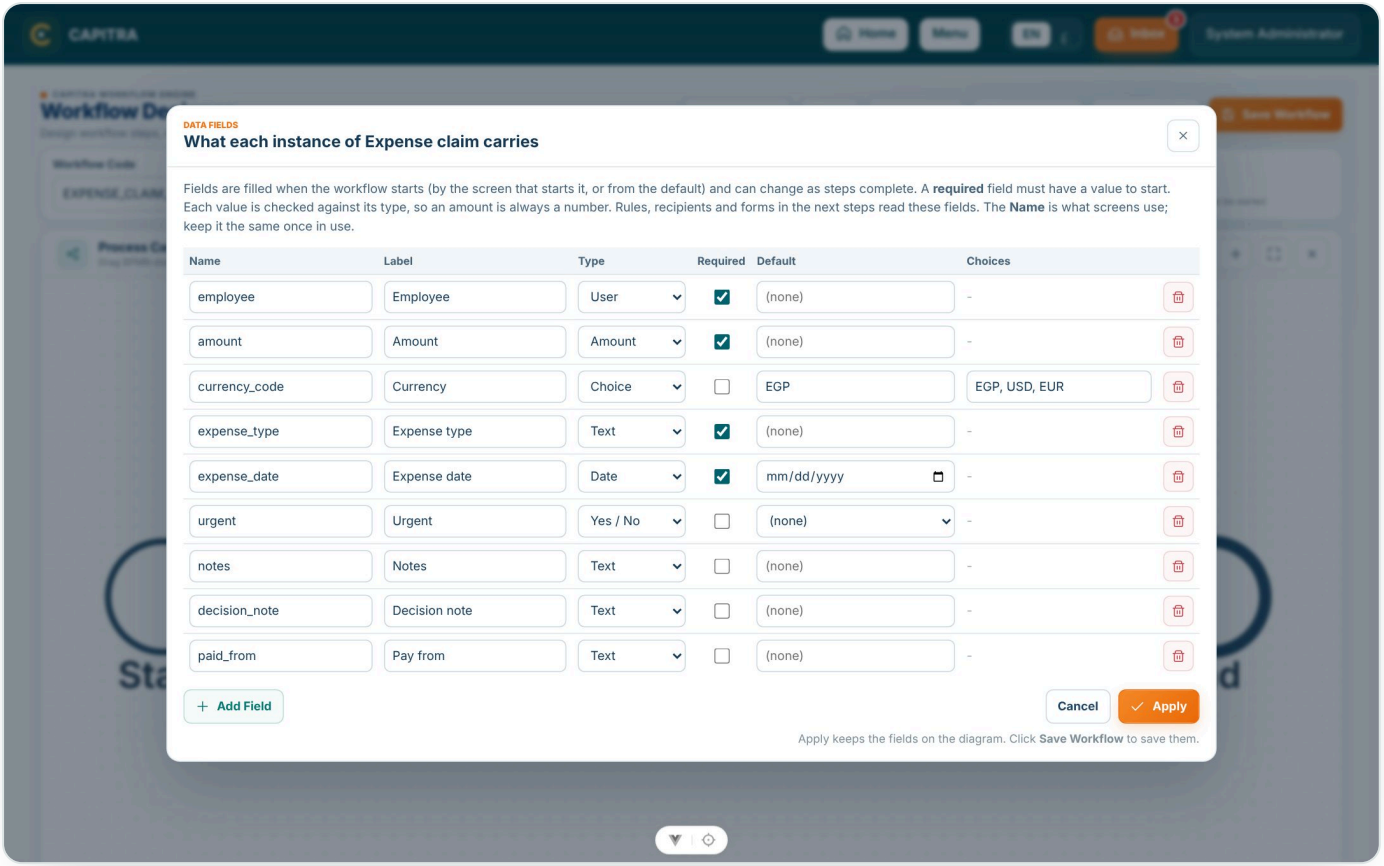


Figure 5. The data fields of the Expense claim workflow. **Apply**, then **Save Workflow**.

TYPE	HOLDS	STORED AS
Text	Any text	As typed
Number	A whole number	`1250`
Amount	An amount with decimals	`1250.50`
Yes / No	Yes or No	`true` / `false`
Date	A date	`2026-11-08`
Choice	One of the listed choices	The choice
User	A user of Capitra	The user name

- When an instance starts, empty fields take their default, every value is checked against its type, and a required field must have a value.
- When a task completes, the values it sends are checked the same way.
- The task page shows the fields under **Workflow data**.

6 Forms and data sources

A form is a page laid out over a workflow's data fields. Use one on a step that has no business screen, so the task is worked on the form, or on the Start event, so people can start the workflow themselves (section 8). Steps with a business screen keep it and show the form read-only.

Data sources

Workspace → **Data Sources**. The lists a form's drop-downs offer. Three are built in and always current: **Users**, **Clients** and **Currencies**. Make your own for anything else: a code, a name and items, each with the value that is stored and the label people see.

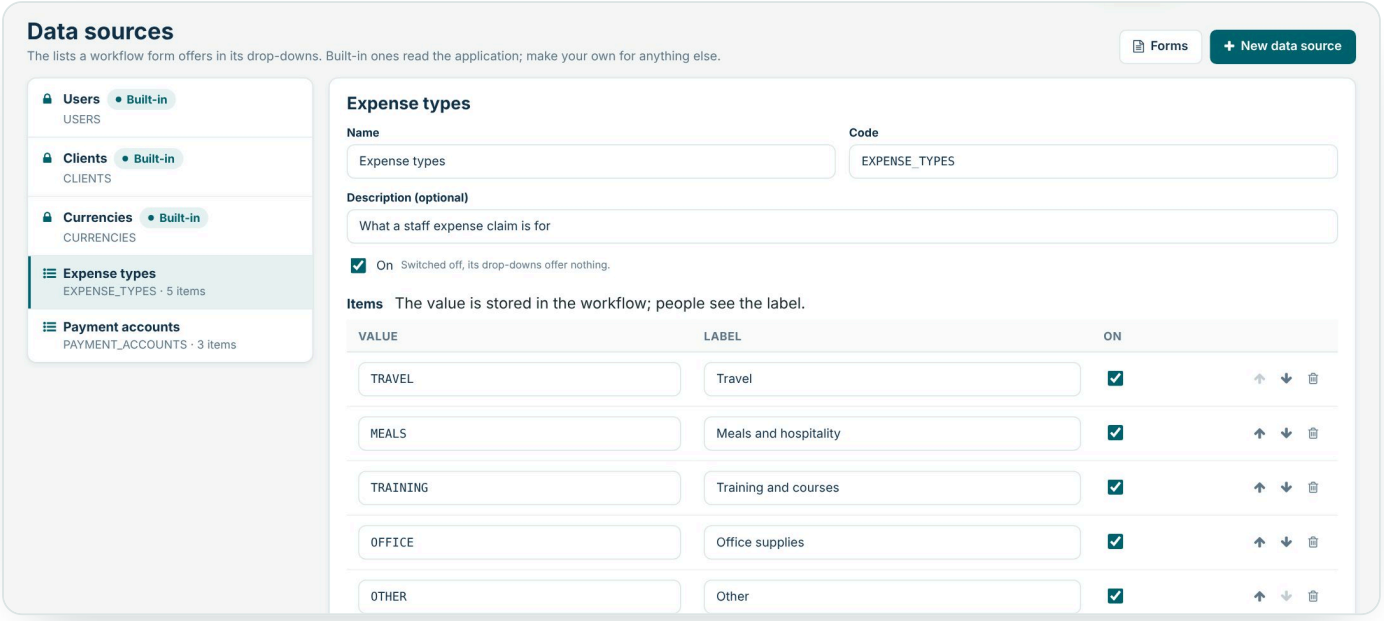


Figure 6. A data source with its items. Switch an item off to stop offering it without losing it.

Building a form

1. Workspace → **Workflow Forms** → **New form**. Give it a name and code and choose its workflow.
2. Under **Add**, click the data fields to put on the form, or **All fields**. Add **Headings** and **Notes** between them.
3. Click a control to set its label, its control type, its data source (for a drop-down), its width on a 2-column form, help text, and whether it is **Required** or **Read-only**.
4. Order the controls with the arrows. The **Preview** shows the form as people will see it.
5. **Create form**.

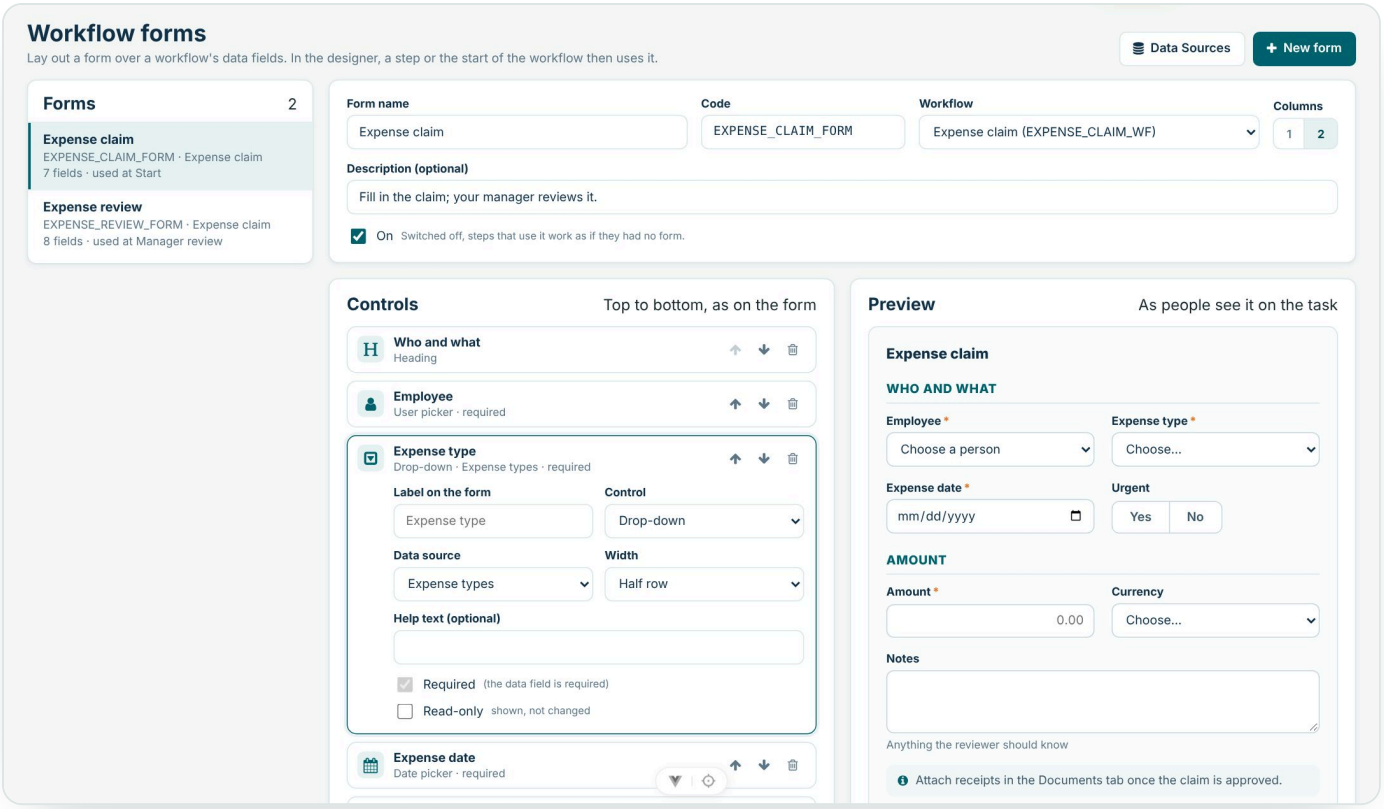


Figure 7. The form designer: controls on the left, live preview on the right.

DATA FIELD TYPE	CONTROLS IT CAN USE
Text	Text box, text area, drop-down
Number	Number, drop-down
Amount	Amount
Yes / No	Yes / No buttons
Date	Date picker
Choice	Drop-down (its own choices, or a data source)
User	User picker

Using a form

In the designer, click the step (or the Start event) and pick the form under **Form**, then **Save Workflow**. **Open this form** goes to the form designer.

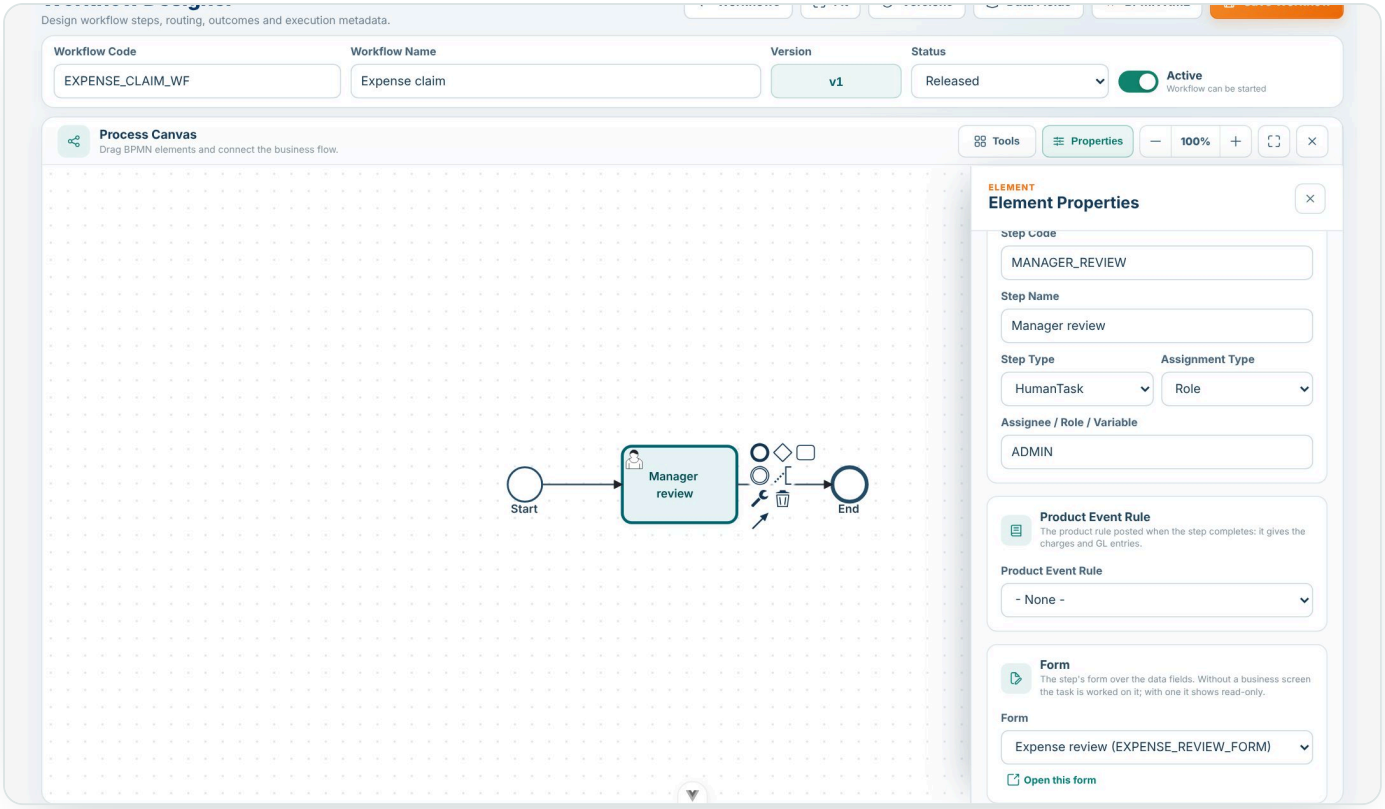


Figure 8. The Manager review step uses the Expense review form.

REMEMBER A form shows only the data fields its workflow declares. Add the field in the designer first. A form in use cannot be deleted; switch it off instead, and steps work as if they had no form.

7 Working your tasks

My Inbox lists the tasks you may work: those assigned to you, to one of your roles, the ones you claimed, and those of people you cover (section 9). Overdue tasks come first. Filter by All, Claimed by me, Unclaimed or Overdue, search, or pick a workflow.

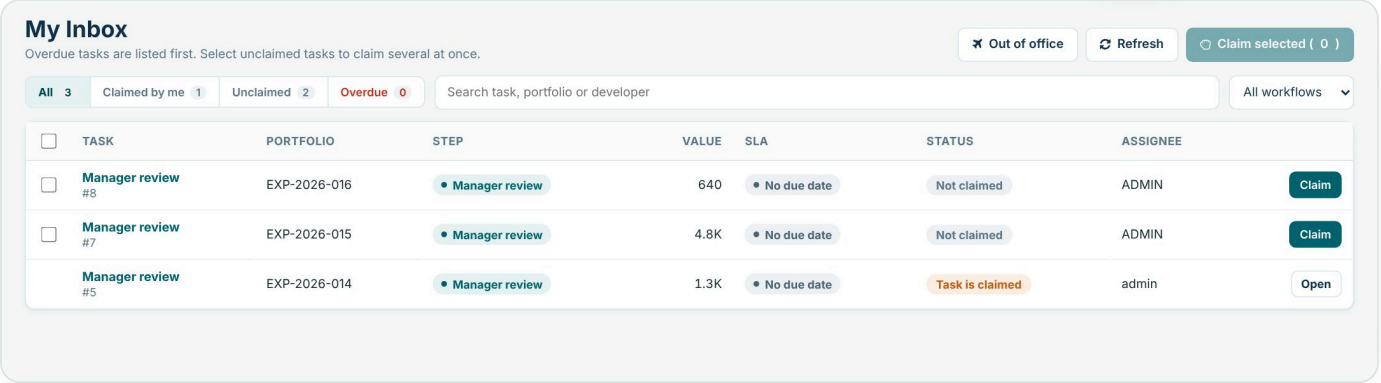


Figure 9. My Inbox. Tick several unclaimed tasks and use **Claim selected** to claim them at once.

The steps of a task

1. **Claim.** The task becomes yours; others in the role no longer see it. — Claimed
2. **Start work.** Opens the business screen, or opens the step's form for filling in. **Continue work** returns to the screen later. — In progress
3. **Complete.** On the business screen, or with the action buttons under the form (Approve, Reject…). Add an optional comment. — Completed

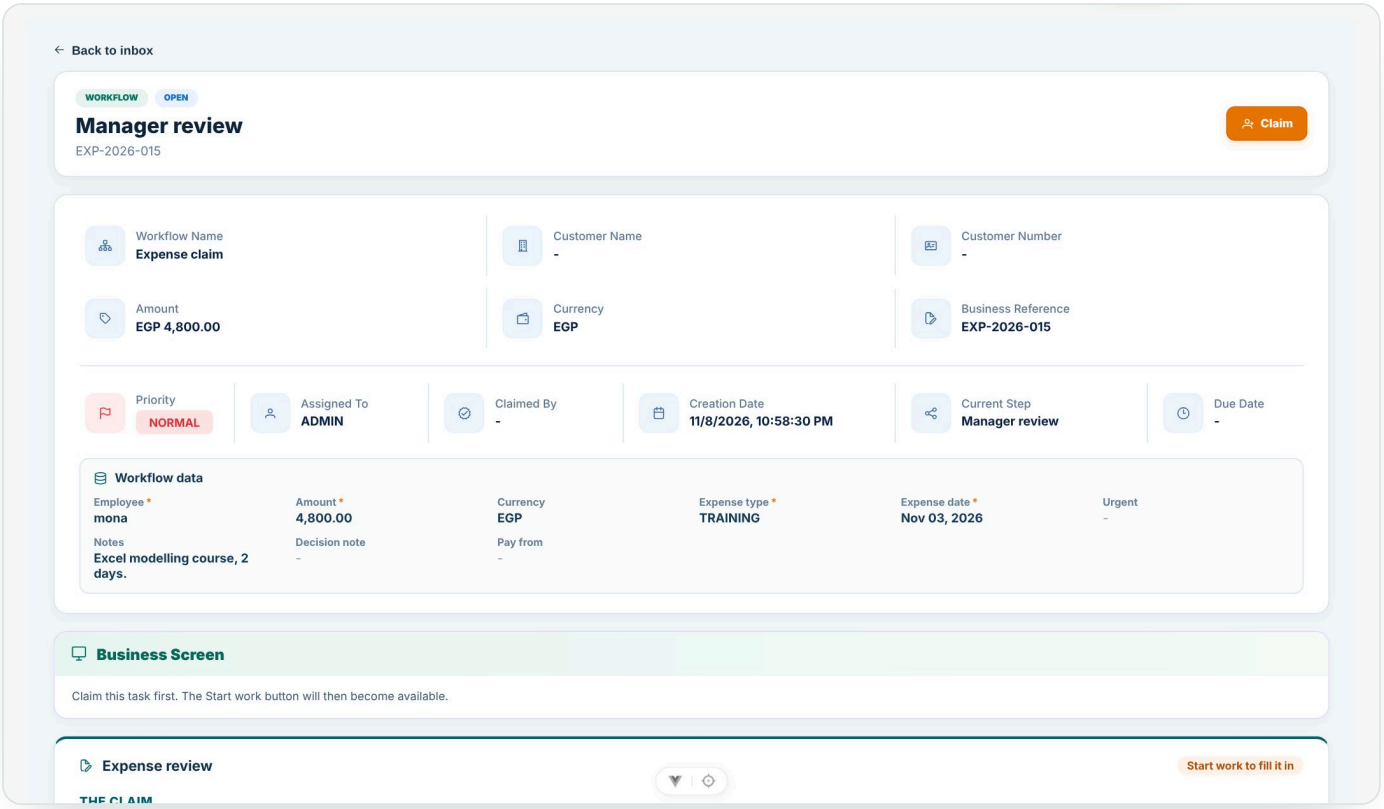


Figure 10. The task page: workflow, customer, amount and reference, who has it, and the workflow data.

A step worked on its form

After **Start work** the form opens for filling in. Required fields carry an orange star. If one is empty, the task is not completed: the message says which field, and what you typed stays on the page. Rejecting or returning a task does not need the form filled in.

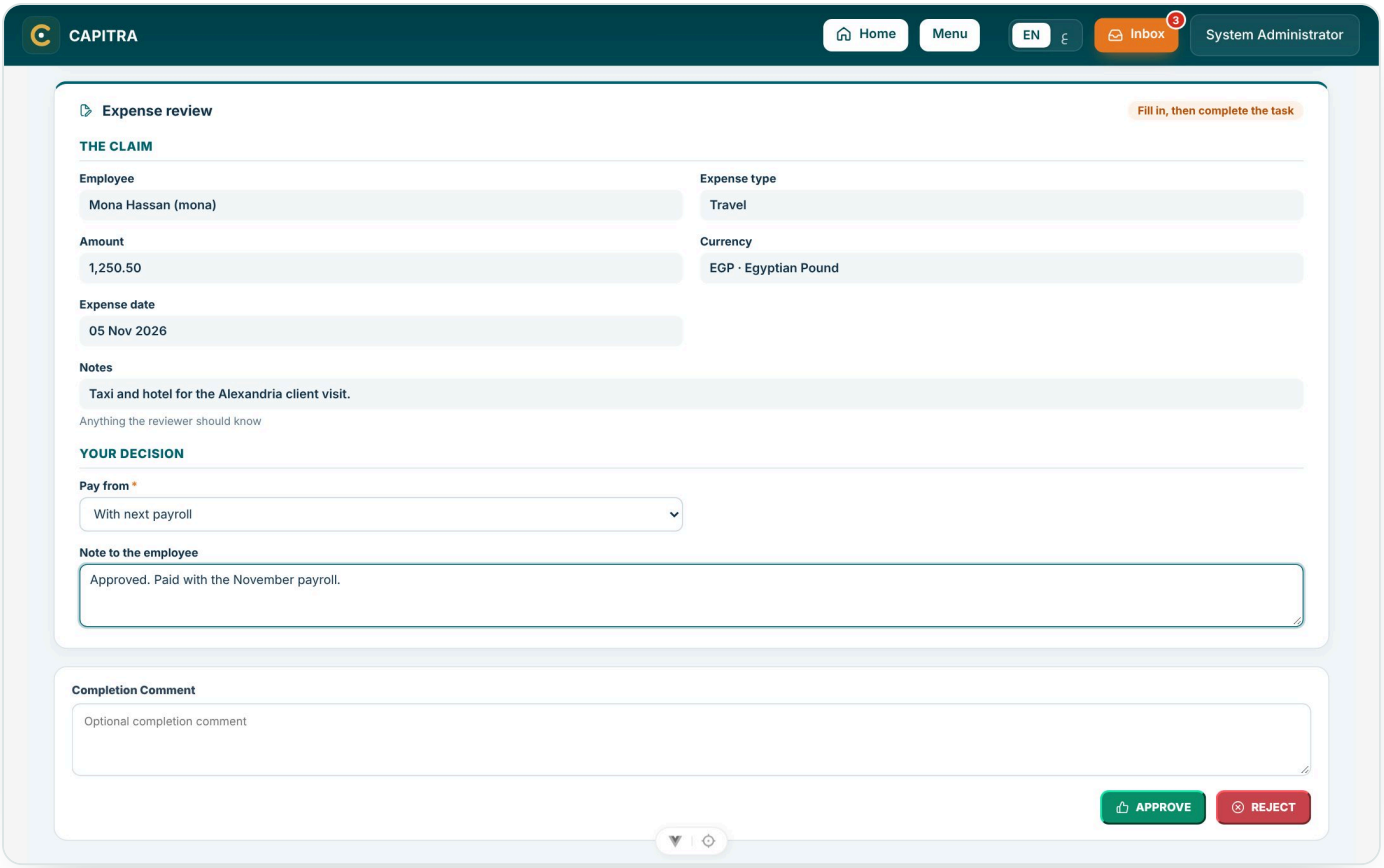


Figure 11. The Expense review form: the claim read-only, the decision to fill in.

8 Starting a workflow

Most workflows are started by their module (a disbursement starts its own). A workflow whose Start event has a form can also be started by anyone from Workspace → **Start a Workflow**.

1. Choose the workflow on the left.
2. Enter a business reference if you have one.
3. Fill in the form. Defaults are already there.
4. **Start workflow**. The message says which step comes next and who has it; **Open the task** goes there if it is yours.

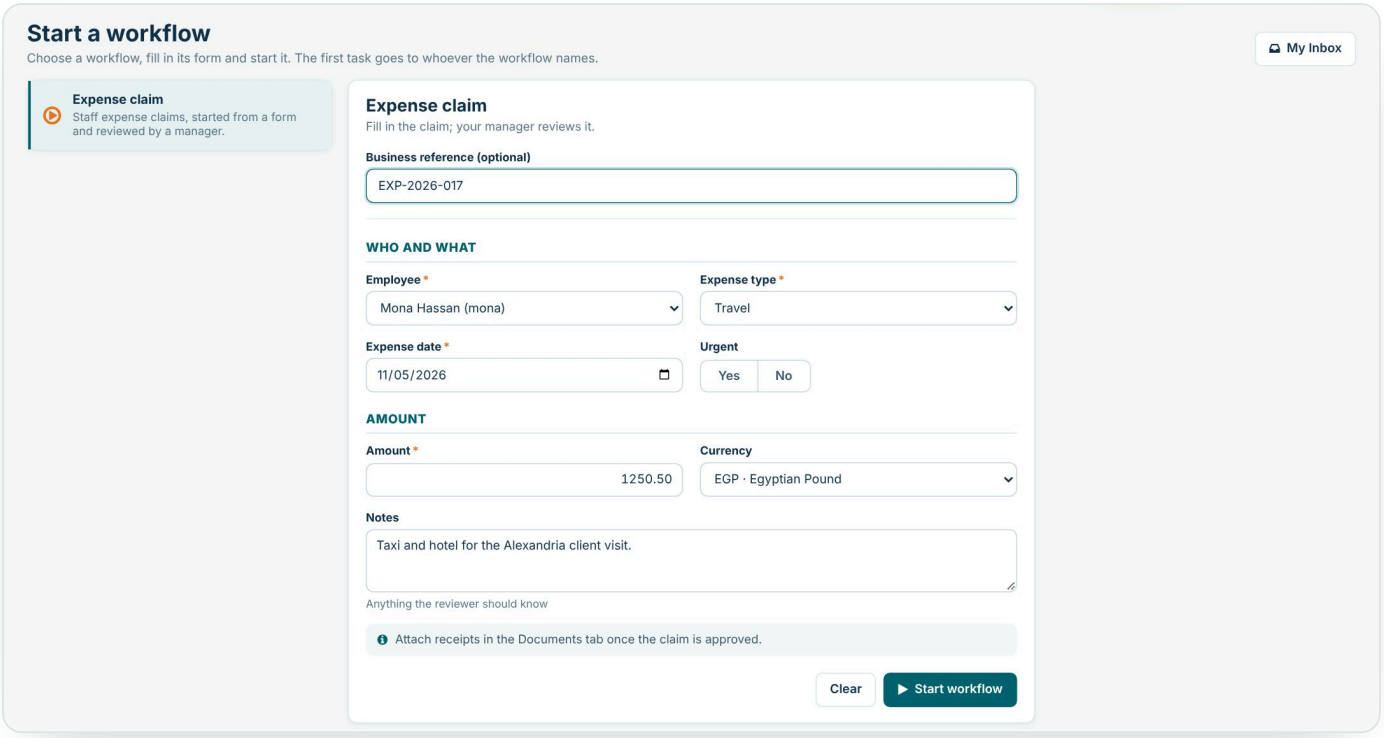


Figure 12. Starting an expense claim.

9 Out of office

Workspace → **Out of Office**, or the button on My Inbox. Choose who works your tasks, for all workflows or one, and the first and last day away. While the dates run:

- New tasks meant for you go to your delegate.
- Your delegate also sees the tasks already waiting for you and for your roles, with a **For <you>** tag, and a banner says whom they cover.
- A task you had claimed shows **Take over**: the delegate claims it from you.
- A rule for one workflow wins over the rule for all workflows. If your delegate is away too, the task passes to their delegate (up to five steps, never back to you).

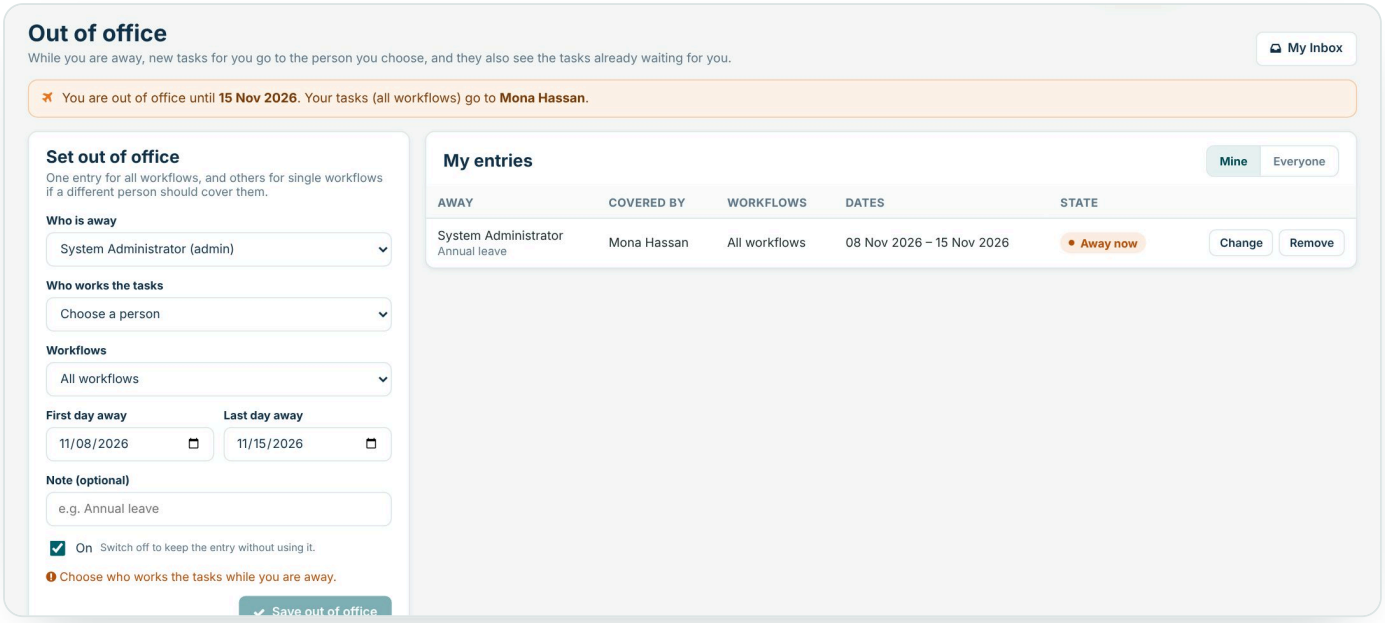


Figure 13. Out of office: the form, and your entries with their state (Away now, Planned, Ended, Off).

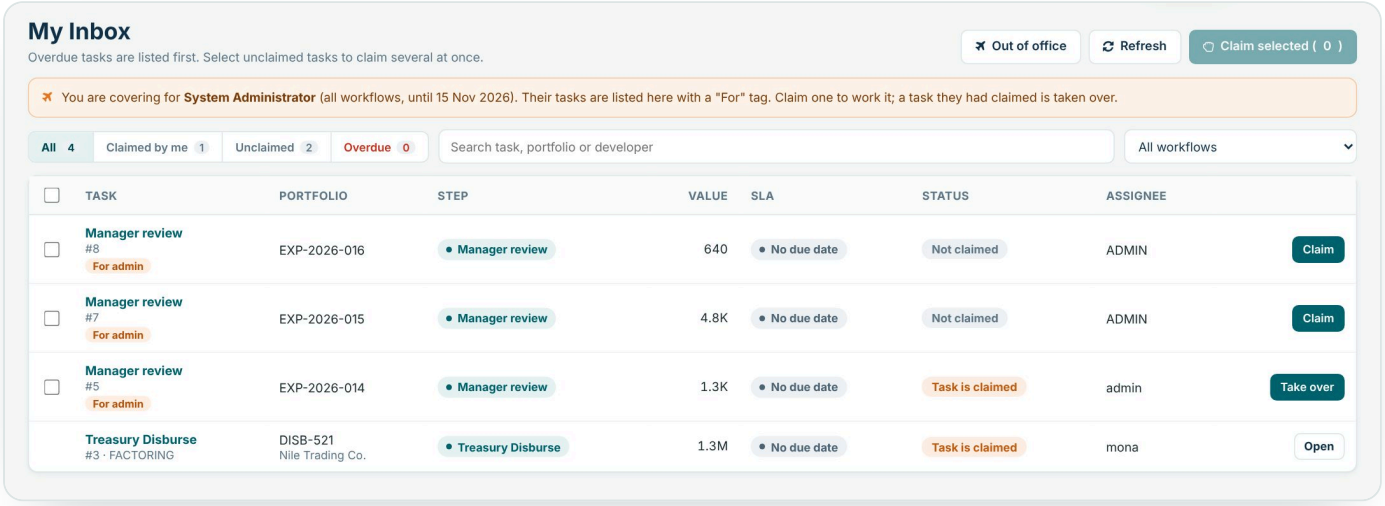


Figure 14. The delegate's inbox: the banner, the **For admin** tags and **Take over**.

TIP Switch an entry **Off** to keep it for next time without using it. Workflow administrators can choose **Everyone** to see and set entries for other people.

10 Messages and what to do

MESSAGE	WHAT TO DO
This task is not assigned to you.	Someone else claimed it, or it is not for your role. Refresh the inbox.
Fill in "...".	A required field of the form is empty. Fill it in and press the action again.
"..." must be one of the listed values.	Choose a value from the drop-down.
The workflow needs "..." to start.	A required data field has no value. Fill it in on the start form.
"..." must be an amount / a whole number / a date.	The value does not fit the field's type. Correct it.
Only a released workflow definition can be started.	In the designer, set Status to Released and save.
... has no start form. Its module starts it.	Start it from its own page, or give its Start event a form.
"..." is not a data field of this workflow.	Add the field in the designer's Data Fields first, or remove it from the form.
The workflow uses ... at ..., so it cannot be deleted.	Take the form off those steps in the designer, or switch it off.
... is already out of office ... Change that entry instead.	Only one entry per person, workflow and dates. Change the existing one.

11 Permissions, statuses, glossary

Permissions

Administration → Roles

PERMISSION	ALLOWS
(signed in)	My Inbox, working your tasks, Start a Workflow, your own out of office
`WFE.DEFINITION.VIEW`	Open the registry, designer, versions, forms and data sources; see all open tasks
`WFE.DEFINITION.EDIT`	Create, change, release and delete workflows, forms and data sources; set out of office for others

Statuses

ITEM	STATUSES
Workflow	Draft · Released, and Active on or off
Instance	Running · Waiting (at a task) · Completed
Task	Open (not claimed) · Claimed · In progress · Completed
Out of office entry	Away now · Planned · Ended · Off

Glossary

TERM	MEANING
BPMN	The standard drawing language of the designer
Delegate	The person who works your tasks while you are out of office
History	The record of every step of an instance: started, entered, claimed, delegated, taken over, completed
Route	The business screen a step opens
SLA	The target time to finish a task
Take over	A delegate claiming a task the away person had claimed